BIO LUXE LAB

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A FREE GUIDE FROM THE BIO LUXE LAB TEAM

The 7-Night Wind-Down Plan

Seven evenings, one small ritual each. Twenty minutes or less a night, nothing to buy, nothing to download. By night seven you will have built an evening routine you actually look forward to.

Keep this on your phone or print it and put it on the bedside table.

BEFORE YOU START

How this plan works

Most evenings end the same way: the big light stays on, the phone comes to bed, and the brain never gets the signal that the day is over. A wind-down routine is simply a short, repeatable sequence that gives it that signal.

Each night below adds one piece. Try it once, keep what you like, drop what you don't. On night seven you stack your favourites into a routine of about twenty minutes that you can repeat every evening.

You will need

- A lamp or candle you can use instead of the ceiling light
- A quiet corner of floor with room to lie down (a mat is nicer, a rug works)
- A notebook and pen
- Something warm and caffeine-free to drink

Optional: a foam roller, a deck of meditation or affirmation cards, and soft sleep headphones for white noise. If you have our Evening Wind-Down Kit they are already on the list.

Three rules

- **Same start time.** Pick a time you can keep on a bad day, not a perfect one. Set a gentle alarm called "lights down".
- **Gentle beats intense.** Nothing here should feel like a workout or a test. If it does, do less.
- **Finish before bed, not in it.** The routine ends when you walk into the bedroom.

This guide is about building a calmer evening habit. It is general wellbeing information, not medical advice, and the products mentioned are relaxation and fitness accessories, not treatments. If you have a health condition, an injury or are pregnant, check with a healthcare professional before starting any new stretching or breathing practice, and stop anything that feels wrong.

NIGHT 1

LIGHT AND SCREENS

The thirty-minute switch-off

Tonight you change nothing except the lighting and the phone. This is the foundation every other night builds on.

0 min	**Lights down.** Turn off the overhead light and switch on a lamp, a salt lamp or a candle. Warm, low light only from here on.
0 min	**Phone on a shelf, not in a pocket.** Do-not-disturb on. Charge it outside the bedroom if you can.
2 min	**Make a warm drink.** Chamomile, rooibos, warm milk or just hot water with a slice of lemon.
5 min	**Sit with the drink and do nothing else.** No screen, no reading yet. Look out of the window or at the candle.
10 min	**Two minutes of box breathing.** Breathe in for 4, hold 4, out for 4, hold 4. Eight rounds. Full instructions on the breathing page.
12 min	**Read something printed.** Fiction or poetry rather than news or work. Ten to fifteen pages is plenty.
30 min	**Bed.** The routine is over when you get there.

The one thing to notice

How different the room feels with the big light off. That contrast is the whole trick: your evening should look and feel different from your day.

NIGHT 2

BREATH

A twelve-minute breathing sequence

Keep last night's lights-down and phone rules. Tonight you replace the reading with a short breathing practice. Sit on a cushion or lie on your mat.

Min 1–3	**Notice.** One hand on the belly, one on the chest. Breathe normally and watch which hand moves. Most of us barely use the belly. No fixing yet, just noticing.
Min 3–6	**Belly breathing.** Breathe in slowly through the nose so the lower hand rises first. Let the breath out fully and feel the hand fall. Long, soft, unhurried.
Min 6–9	**Box breathing.** In for 4, hold 4, out for 4, hold 4. Count on your fingers if it helps. Keep the effort gentle.
Min 9–12	**4-7-8.** In quietly through the nose for 4, hold for 7, out through the mouth with a soft whoosh for 8. Four rounds, then let the breath go back to normal and sit for a moment.

Common mistakes

- Slouching: sit tall or lie flat so the lungs have room.
- Forcing big inhales: the calming part is the slow exhale.
- Only doing it when stressed: the habit builds on calm nights so it is there on hard ones.

If you feel light-headed

Shorten the holds or skip them and breathe in for 4, out for 6 instead. Comfortable always wins over correct.

NIGHT 3

MOVEMENT

Five slow floor stretches

Lights down, phone away, then roll out a mat or lie on a rug. Hold each shape for five slow breaths. Nothing should pull or hurt; back off until it feels like a stretch you could stay in.

1. **Cat and cow.** On hands and knees. Breathe in and let the belly drop and the chest open; breathe out and round the spine towards the ceiling. Eight slow rounds.
2. **Child's pose.** Knees wide, big toes together, sit back towards the heels and rest your forehead on the mat or a block. Arms forward or by your sides. Five breaths.
3. **Seated forward fold.** Legs out in front, a soft bend in the knees. Fold from the hips and let the head hang. Hands wherever they land. Five breaths.
4. **Reclined butterfly.** Lie on your back, soles of the feet together, knees falling open. A block or cushion under each knee makes it restful. Five to ten breaths.
5. **Lying twist.** Knees to chest, then let them fall to one side while the arms stretch out. Five breaths each side. Finish lying flat for a minute.

Make it easy

Leave the mat rolled out where you will see it in the evening. A visible mat gets used; one in a cupboard does not. A yoga block under the knees or forehead turns every one of these into a rest rather than an effort.

NIGHT 4

RELEASE

The eight-minute roll

If you have a foam roller, tonight is its night. If not, a rolled towel or a tennis ball against the wall covers most of this. Slow is the whole point: move about an inch a second and breathe out as you roll.

1 min	**Calves.** Sit with the roller under one calf, other foot on the floor. Roll ankle to knee. Swap.
2 min	**Hamstrings.** Roller under the back of the thighs, hands behind you. Roll knee to hip, slowly.
1 min	**Glutes.** Sit on the roller, cross one ankle over the opposite knee and lean towards the crossed side. Small movements. Swap.
2 min	**Upper back.** Roller across the shoulder blades, hands behind the head, hips on the floor. Roll a few inches up and down. Stay off the lower back and neck.
1 min	**Lats.** Lie on one side, arm overhead, roller under the armpit area. Rock gently. Swap.
1 min	**Lie still.** Flat on the mat, arms out, eyes closed. Three slow breaths before you get up.

Grooved or smooth?

A grooved roller gives more sensation; if it feels too intense, put a folded blanket over it or use less body weight. It should feel like firm pressure, never sharp.

Leave out

Joints, the lower back, the neck, and anywhere bruised or injured. If something hurts rather than feels tight, stop and move on.

NIGHT
5

MIND

Empty the head onto paper

Lights down, drink in hand, notebook open. Tonight is about getting the unfinished day out of your head so it is not still running when you lie down.

5 min	**Brain dump.** Write every task, worry, idea and "must remember" on one page. Do not organise it. The page holds it now, not you.
2 min	**Tomorrow's first three.** Circle the three things that matter most tomorrow and write them at the top of a fresh page. Close the notebook on the rest.
3 min	**Three good things.** Write three things from today you are glad happened. Small counts: a good coffee, a kind message, finishing early.
3 min	**Draw a card.** If you have meditation or affirmation cards, pull one at random, read it slowly and leave it face up on the bedside table as tomorrow morning's first thought. No cards? Write one line you want to carry into tomorrow.

Why it works

The brain keeps rehearsing open loops. Writing them down tells it they are stored somewhere safe. The gratitude lines shift what you are chewing on as you fall asleep, and the card gives the next morning a soft landing.

NIGHT 6

SPACE

The ten-minute bedroom reset

Tonight the routine moves into the bedroom for a one-off reset. Once it is done you only maintain it.

Cool	Turn the radiator down or crack a window an hour before bed. Most people sleep more comfortably in a cool room (around 18 °C is a common guide) with a warm duvet.
Dark	Close curtains fully, cover or turn off standby lights, and put a sleep mask by the pillow for mornings when the light comes early.
Quiet	If noise is a problem, try a steady background sound: a fan, rain audio or white noise. A soft sleep headband with flat speakers lets you do this without disturbing anyone else or wearing earbuds.
Clear	Clear the bedside table down to a lamp, a book, your notebook and tonight's card. Put the phone charger in another room.
Scent	Optional: a drop of lavender oil on a tissue by the pillow, or a diffuser on a timer. Pick one scent and keep it for evenings only.

The bedroom's one job

Try to keep work, scrolling and TV out of the bedroom for the rest of the week. The more the room is used only for rest, the faster it starts to feel like rest when you walk in.

NIGHT 7

STACK IT

Your twenty-minute routine

You have tried six pieces. Tonight you build your own routine from the ones that felt best, write it on the card below, and repeat it every evening from here.

A routine that works for most people

0–2 min	Lights down, phone away, warm drink on
2–8 min	Three floor stretches (child's pose, butterfly, lying twist) or the eight-minute roll
8–12 min	Box breathing then four rounds of 4-7-8
12–18 min	Brain dump, three good things, draw a card
18–20 min	Walk to a cool, dark bedroom. Routine over.

My routine

Start time: _____ Where: _____

1. _____ ____ min

2. _____ ____ min

3. _____ ____ min

4. _____ ____ min

Use the tracker on the next page for the first week. Aim for five nights out of seven. A missed night is just a missed night; the routine is still yours the next evening.

YOUR FIRST WEEK

7-night tracker

Tick what you did. Three ticks in a row is a routine.

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Lights down by my start time							
Phone out of the bedroom							
Breathing (box or 4-7-8)							
Stretch or roll							
Brain dump and three good things							
Card drawn and left out							
Cool, dark, quiet bedroom							
How I felt at lights-out (1–5)							

Breathing cheat sheet

Belly breathing. Hand on the belly. In through the nose so the hand rises; out slowly so it falls. Any time, any place.

Box. In 4 · hold 4 · out 4 · hold 4. Eight rounds. Good for the first minutes of the routine.

4-7-8. In 4 · hold 7 · out 8 with a soft whoosh. Four rounds, then normal breathing. The last thing before bed.

Light-headed? Drop the holds: in 4, out 6, until it settles.

WHAT NEXT

Make the routine easy to keep

Everything in this plan works with what you already own. Three things make it easier to keep going: a mat you leave out, a roller by the sofa, and a deck of cards on the bedside table. We put those three together, with a few extras, as the **Evening Wind-Down Kit**.

The Evening Wind-Down Kit

- Essential 4 mm anti-slip yoga and Pilates mat, folds flat
- Grooved EPP foam roller for the eight-minute roll
- Thirty-six monochrome watercolour meditation cards for Night 5
- Joe's follow-along evening routine video and the printable 30-day routine tracker
- Free UK delivery, and our 30-Night Promise: use it for a month and if it is not for you, send it back for a refund

bioluxelab.com/products/evening-wind-down-kit

Your first order comes with a bonus

Everyone who places a first order with us gets the full 30-Day Routine Tracker pack and early access to Joe's new routine videos. No code needed; it is added to your order confirmation automatically.

Questions? Reply to the email this came with, or write to info@bioluxelab.com. We are a small UK team and we read everything.